

Masterclass: Tax and Transfer Policy Evaluation

Session 1: Structures In and Structures Out

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May 18, 2026

Where to Find GETTSIM

- Documentation (user-facing): <https://gettsim.readthedocs.io>
- Source code and issues: <https://github.com/ttsim-dev/gettsim>
- Personas package: <https://github.com/ttsim-dev/gettsim-personas>

GEPs: Why They Matter

- GEPs are GETTSIM Enhancement Protocols: architecture and style rules.
- Key ones for users:
 - GEP-07: user interface and `main()`.
 - GEP-06: namespaces and qualified names.
 - GEP-01/02: naming and data structure conventions.
 - GEP-04: DAG-based computation model.
- Use GEPs when API behavior seems non-obvious.

Session Workflow Around `main()`

- Set `policy_date_str` first.
- Choose `main_target` (what should come back).
- Provide `input_data` (DataFrame+mapper or tree).
- Define `tt_targets` (what to compute).
- Run and inspect outputs or missing-input diagnostics.

Diagnostic Workflow (Notebook)

- Start with a small target set.
- Run once and read missing roots.
- Add coherent branches (not random leaves).
- Re-run and compare reduced missing lists.
- Use personas once the concept is clear.

What is gettsim-personas?

- A collection of stylized household setups for GETTSIM.
- It provides coherent `input_data_tree` and often useful target bundles.
- In class: ideal for robust runs after learning custom DataFrame mapping.